

Chapter 170-2

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Confirming something was easy to say but not simple to do.

With the New Year approaching, many things piled up together. Everyone was too busy to manage, so the matter was temporarily set aside.

After the New Year passed, Xu Qingzhu was busy for quite a while.

Liang Shi didn't rest either. Through Chang Hui's negotiations, she auditioned for two dramas and ultimately secured the role of the second female lead in a historical costume drama.

Once the Lantern Festival¹ passed, she began recording the travel variety show *"Let's Go, Right Now."*

This program had started recording after the New Year, and reportedly had already filmed up to the third episode. Liang Shi would appear as a flying guest² in episodes 4, 5, and 6.

At the same time, *"Journey of the Heart"* was scheduled to release on April 11th.

"Let's Go, Right Now" used a 4+3 format—four fixed guests plus three flying guests.

There would be twelve episodes in total, expected to air in early March.

There were some leaked photos of the show online, but very few.

The production team protected it well. From the limited information online, one could only tell that the fixed MCs included a popular young idol, an aloof Best Actor, an experienced host, and one person whose identity hadn't been revealed at all.

The popular young idol was famously bad-tempered, the aloof Best Actor was known for his zen-like personality, and the host had been honed through various major award ceremonies.

One could tell at a glance that sparks would fly when they came together.

Liang Shi also asked Chang Hui what she needed to be aware of.

Chang Hui thought for a moment before telling her, "One of them brought investment into the show. If you can build a good relationship, then do so. If you can't... just don't provoke her."

Perhaps because she knew Liang Shi also had backing, her words weren't too harsh.

As for who would be parachuting in³ alongside her, Liang Shi didn't know either.

Chang Hui didn't tell her, saying that since it was a reality show, what they wanted was the most instinctive reactions. Telling her in advance would ruin the dramatic effect.

The reality shows here were similar to the ones Liang Shi had participated in before, though comparatively, this one was more authentic.

It placed more emphasis on the first two characters⁴ rather than the last one.

Back when Liang Shi used to film reality shows, a single entrance shot might need to be filmed seven or eight times.

And she'd heard of celebrities who had to film twenty or thirty takes.

When reality shows lose their authenticity, they also lose that purity.

The audience knew it was all an act, so naturally the ratings couldn't hold up.

Some netizens even joked that variety show regulars had better acting skills than actual actors.

So this program would start airing after filming two episodes, mainly to leave time for post-production editing and subtitles. After that, it would basically be filmed weekly and aired weekly—not quite real-time, but close to it.

Post-production could adjust the recording style and guest invitations based on audience feedback.

The recording location for this show was in the south, by the sea.

Liang Shi would be away for a week.

Xu Qingzhu had known about this for a while, but when she heard Liang Shi say she'd be leaving for a week, her face still fell. That evening, she even followed her into the kitchen while she was cooking. "Why is it so long?"

Liang Shi chuckled softly. "This variety show is travel-themed, so it takes longer."

Ordinary variety show recordings only took a day or two.

"You might as well just film a drama then," Xu Qingzhu said.

"Compared to variety shows, I also prefer filming dramas," Liang Shi said as she placed the food on the dining table. "But variety shows help artists maintain exposure, so I still need to participate. I've calculated it—by the time this finishes airing, *Journey of the Heart* will be coming out, so... it's good for the movie too."

Xu Qingzhu shook her head. "Being an actor is really hard work."

Hearing this, Liang Shi smiled softly and picked up some food with her chopsticks for her. "Not as hard as what you do."

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

"That's true," Xu Qingzhu said. "We do work quite hard, after all, we're supporting so many artists."

Liang Shi was amused by her, but played along. "Yes, yes, yes. So your artist is going out to work hard now."

"Alright then." Xu Qingzhu raised an eyebrow and patted her shoulder. "Xiao Liang, work hard so I can buy a house soon."

Liang Shi: "?"

"You're still short of houses?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu nodded calmly. "Of course."

"To keep a beauty in a golden house⁵, I'm just missing the golden house," Xu Qingzhu said.

Liang Shi: "....."

"Alright," Liang Shi said. "Then I'll work harder so President Xu can buy a golden house."

"When the time comes, will you walk in yourself, or should I tie you up and drag you in?" Xu Qingzhu asked leisurely, drawing out her words.

Liang Shi: "I'll carry you in."

Xu Qingzhu: "Hm?"

Liang Shi curled her finger and lightly tapped her. "If the golden house only hides me, then it loses its meaning."

Xu Qingzhu: "So?"

"I need to bring you in too," Liang Shi said. "That way it'll be properly hidden."

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

"I'm not going," Xu Qingzhu said. "I need to earn money to support the family."

"What about me then?" Liang Shi said. "Do I just lie in the golden house and never come out?"

Xu Qingzhu nodded. "Sure."

Liang Shi flicked her forehead again. "Stop playing around, let's eat. Always saying such improper things."

Xu Qingzhu shrugged. "What proper things do I have to say to you?"

Liang Shi: "....."

Footnotes:

¹ **Lantern Festival (元宵節):** A Chinese festival celebrated on the 15th day of the first lunar month, marking the end of the Chinese New Year celebrations. It typically falls in February or early March.

² **Flying guest (飛行嘉賓):** A term used in Chinese variety shows referring to guest stars who appear for one or a few episodes, as opposed to the regular/fixed cast members.

³ **Parachuting in (空降):** Entertainment industry slang for someone suddenly joining a show or project, often referring to guest appearances.

⁴ **First two characters vs last one:** In Chinese, "真人秀" (zhēnrénxiù) means "reality show." The first two characters "真人" mean "real person/authentic," while the last character "秀" means "show." The author is saying this program emphasizes authenticity over performance.

⁵ **Golden house to hide a beauty (金屋藏嬌):** A famous Chinese idiom originating from Emperor Wu of Han, who as a child said he would build a golden house to keep his cousin Chen Ajiao (whom he later married). It now refers to keeping a beloved woman in luxurious hidden quarters, often with connotations of keeping a mistress.